

Art Direction & Scenes

Concept, 6 Planned Scenes, Aesthetic Vision

March 31, 2026

ClawCraft Project Reference

Artistic Vision

ClawCraft explores childhood game worlds colliding with mundane adult spaces. The aesthetic is photorealistic domestic environments containing low-poly game-world elements -- as if reality has a rendering glitch and game geometry is leaking through.

The contrast between rendering styles is the point. Realistic PBR lighting falls on blocky voxel terrain. Normal kitchen objects sit next to golden apples and potion bottles. A hallway degrades in fidelity like a video game running out of draw distance.

Both successes and failures are part of the work. A render where the AI misunderstands scale or materials is still interesting -- it reveals how the LLM interprets spatial concepts. Happy accidents (unintended results that produce interesting art) are tracked as a specific outcome type in the logging system.

The 6 Planned Scenes

1. fridge_portal

An open refrigerator. Instead of food inside, a blocky low-poly landscape extends to the horizon -- voxel terrain with pixel trees and an 8-bit sky. Kitchen lighting spills through the fridge door into the game world. The door frame is the boundary between realities.

Transgression: domestic space containing an infinite game world. Scale violation -- the interior is impossibly larger than the exterior.

Key challenges: getting the lighting transition right at the threshold, making the low-poly landscape read as intentionally stylized rather than just bad, balancing the photorealistic kitchen with the flat-shaded game world.

2. shelf_artifacts

A kitchen shelf holding normal objects (coffee mugs, plates, a cookbook) alongside low-poly game objects -- a potion bottle, a golden apple, a diamond pickaxe. Realistic PBR lighting hits everything equally. The game objects don't belong, but the lighting says they do.

Transgression: game items treated as mundane household objects. Perception -- the lighting and placement normalize the impossible.

Key challenges: material contrast (PBR ceramics vs flat-shaded game geometry), making the composition feel like a still life rather than random placement, scale consistency between realistic and game objects.

3. bathtub_overflow

A bathtub filled with low-poly water -- flat blue planes with no transparency or refraction. Voxel fish swim in it. The water spilling over the edge of the tub transforms into realistic water as it hits the tile floor. Two rendering styles collide at the bathtub rim.

Transgression: physics and rendering style change at a boundary. The same substance (water) exists in two visual

realities simultaneously.

Key challenges: the transition zone where low-poly meets realistic, making the voxel fish read clearly, the floor water needs to look convincingly real while the tub water is deliberately flat.

4. window_gameworld

A normal room interior. Through the window, instead of a neighborhood, there's a retro game landscape -- flat green ground plane, cube trees, a pixelated sun disc. Realistic curtains frame the view. The lighting transition happens at the windowsill.

Transgression: the exterior world has been replaced by a game level. Space -- looking through a real window into an unreal world.

Key challenges: the window frame as a clean boundary between styles, getting the game-world lighting to feel like it's actually coming through the window, curtain material against the flat game sky.

5. dining_dungeon

A dining table set normally -- plates, glasses, napkins, a centerpiece. Under the table, visible through the chair legs, a dungeon entrance: stone block walls, wall-mounted torches casting orange glow, a dark stone staircase descending. Kitchen overhead light competes with dungeon glow under the table.

Transgression: a game dungeon existing beneath ordinary furniture. Space and perception -- the underside of a dining table opens into another genre entirely.

Key challenges: dual lighting (kitchen fluorescent vs torch glow), the stone blocks need to look deliberately game-like not just low-res, the transition between hardwood floor and dungeon stone.

6. hallway_renderdist

A normal residential hallway. Objects in the foreground are photorealistic. As you look deeper into the hallway, objects gradually degrade -- first textures simplify, then geometry becomes blockier, until the far end of the hallway is full N64-era low-poly. Fog at the far wall. The transition is gradual, not a hard cutoff.

Transgression: render distance applied to reality. The hallway exists at multiple levels of detail simultaneously, like a game engine running out of LOD budget.

Key challenges: making the gradual transition feel smooth rather than banded, the fog needs to feel atmospheric not just obscuring, choosing recognizable hallway objects (coat rack, shoes, pictures) that degrade interestingly.

Render Settings

- Engine: EEVEE (BLENDER_EEVEE) -- never Cycles (hangs on Metal headless)
- Resolution: 1920x1080 RGBA PNG
- File naming: {scene_id}_{iteration:003}.png
- Minimum 3 iterations per scene

- At least 1 scene with 5+ iterations for deep refinement
- 3 scenes selected as final art pieces
- Physics/animation attempt on at least 1 scene

DALL-E Concept Art (required)

Must generate concept art with gpt-image-1 for at least 2 scenes before committing to 3D. This satisfies the second ML architecture requirement (diffusion/autoregressive). Quick concept sketches to explore composition before Blender work. Has NOT been done yet.